

Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Seven Hundred Lines

Āryasaptaśatikānāmaprajñāpāramitāmahāyānasūtra · Toh 90 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་རལ་ཏུ་ཕྱུ་བྱེ་པ་བདུ་བར་མེད་པུ་

Toh 90 in the Kangyur is the Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Seven Hundred Verses, known in Sanskrit as the Āryasaptaśatikā Prajñāpāramitā Mahāyāna Sūtra and in Tibetan as འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་རལ་ཏུ་ཕྱུ་བྱེ་པ་བདུ་བར་མེད་པུ་. It is a Mahāyāna sūtra belonging to the Perfection of Wisdom family of texts, presenting teachings on prajñāpāramitā — the wisdom that transcends ordinary understanding and lies at the heart of the bodhisattva path. The text is set at Śrāvastī, where the Buddha addresses a vast assembly of monks and bodhisattvas, and its content is framed as a prophetic discourse concerning the Perfection of Wisdom in seven hundred verses. Within the Kangyur, it forms the forty-sixth chapter of the Noble Great Jewel Heap, a vast collection containing one hundred thousand chapters of Dharma categories, placing this sūtra within one of the most expansive groupings of canonical Buddhist scripture.

Translated by the Śes-sde translation team, edited and finalized.

This is the forty-sixth chapter of the noble Great Jewel Heap, which contains one hundred thousand chapters of Dharma categories: the sūtra prophesying the noble Perfection of Wisdom in Seven Hundred Verses. First fascicle.

In Sanskrit: Āryasaptaśatikānāmaprajñāpāramitāmahāyānasūtra.

In Tibetan: the sūtra of the Great Vehicle called the Noble Perfection of Wisdom in Seven Hundred Verses.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of fully one thousand monks. Also dwelling there together were ten million bodhisattvas, great beings who had donned the great armor and who were all irreversible from unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening. Among them were Mañjuśrī the youthful, Maitreya, Unimpeded Confidence, Steadfast Effort, and others, as well as yet another ten million bodhisattvas.

Then Mañjuśrī the youthful, at the time when dawn was breaking, set out from his own dwelling in order to behold the Tathāgata, to pay homage, and to

attend upon him. He went to the gate of the Tathāgata's palace and took up his place standing at the outer side of that gate. And the venerable Śāriputra likewise set out from his own dwelling in order to behold the Blessed One, to pay homage, and to attend upon him, and he went to the gate of the Tathāgata's palace. Then the venerable Pūrṇa Maitrāyaṇīputra, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the venerable Mahākāśyapa, the venerable Mahākātyāyana, the venerable Mahākoṣṭhila — all of them and also the other great śrāvakas — each set out from their own dwellings, went to the gate of the Blessed One's palace, and stood assembled together in one place.

Then the Blessed One, knowing that the great śrāvakas had come and gathered together, arose from within his palace, and having placed a seat at one side outside the palace, he sat down. Having sat, the Blessed One, knowing full well, spoke to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, why have you come in the early morning and taken your place at the gate of the Tathāgata's palace?" When he had so spoken, the venerable Śāriputra addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, it was Mañjuśrī the youthful who arrived first at the gate of the Tathāgata's palace, before any of the rest. As for me, Blessed One, I came along after, wishing to behold the Blessed One."

Then the Blessed One, knowing full well, spoke to Mañjuśrī the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, is it true that you arrived first before all others at the gate of the Tathāgata's palace, in order to behold the Tathāgata, to pay homage, and to attend upon him?" When he had so spoken, Mañjuśrī the youthful addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, it is so. Sugata, it is just so. I set out first of all from my own dwelling in order to behold the Tathāgata, to pay homage, and to attend upon him. I went to the gate of the Tathāgata's palace and took up my place in one direction to the side. And why is that? Blessed One, because I felt an insatiable desire to behold the Tathāgata, to pay homage, and to attend upon him. Blessed One, thus I came to behold the Tathāgata and —

— to pay homage and to attend upon him: that, too, was for the sake of all sentient beings. Blessed One, if one is to behold the Tathāgata, pay homage, and attend upon him, then one should behold him as I behold him, pay homage as I pay homage, and attend upon him as I attend upon him. That is how one should behold, that is how one should pay homage, that is how one should attend. In this way, from the beholding of the Tathāgata through to the attending upon him, it shall be so. Blessed One, I behold the Tathāgata for the sake of all sentient beings."

The Blessed One then spoke: "Mañjuśrī, how does one behold the Tathāgata?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "One beholds the Tathāgata in the mode of non-apprehension, in the aspect of suchness, and in the aspect of non-conceptuality. Likewise, one beholds the Tathāgata in the aspect of non-arising through to the aspect of non-existence of things. Suchness has no arising whatsoever — and thus one beholds the Tathāgata. Suchness neither arises nor ceases — and thus one beholds the Tathāgata. Suchness does not abide in any domain, nor does it abide in any direction — and thus one beholds the Tathāgata. Suchness is not past, not future, not present — and thus one beholds the Tathāgata. Suchness is not distinguished by duality, nor is it distinguished by non-duality — and thus one beholds the Tathāgata. Suchness is not subject to defilement, nor is it subject to purification — and thus one beholds the Tathāgata. Suchness neither arises nor ceases — and thus one beholds the Tathāgata. This is how one beholds the Tathāgata, pays homage, and attends upon him."

When he had so spoken, the Blessed One addressed Mañjuśrī the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, having beheld in this way, what did you see?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, having beheld in this way, I saw nothing whatsoever. Blessed One, in the same way I saw no phenomenon arising and no phenomenon ceasing."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra said this to Mañjuśrī the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, this beholding of the Tathāgata and this attending upon him that you have performed — and the fact that, though you abide close to all sentient beings with great loving-kindness, you have no apprehension of them as sentient beings, no fixation upon them as sentient beings; and though you have entered upon the path for the complete passing into nirvāṇa of all sentient beings, not the slightest fixation upon them as sentient beings arises in you; and the fact that you have donned the armor for the sake of all sentient beings in the mode of non-apprehension, in the mode of non-existence of things, and in the mode of being without discouragement — this is your great undertaking of hardship."

When he had so spoken, Mañjuśrī the youthful said to the venerable Śāradvatīputra: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, it is just as you have said. I have donned this very armor for the complete passing into nirvāṇa of all sentient beings, and yet I have no apprehension of sentient beings whatsoever, nor any fixation upon sentient beings. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I did not do that

armor thinking, 'How shall I diminish or fill up the realm of sentient beings?'"

The venerable Śāradvatīputra, holding Mañjuśrī close in examination, then said: "Suppose that in each and every buddha-field there abide as many buddhas, Blessed Ones, as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges, and that each of those Tathāgatas teaches the Dharma day and night, and that they remain so for as many aeons as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges, and that the number of sentient beings tamed by each teaching of the Dharma by each of those buddhas, the Blessed Ones — as many as grains of sand in the river Ganges — is the same number tamed by each teaching of the Dharma by each Tathāgata: even so, there would be no diminishing or filling up of the realm of sentient beings. Why is that? Because sentient beings are empty of sentient beings, and because sentient beings are not sentient beings. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the realm of sentient beings does not appear to diminish or to fill up."

When he had so spoken, the venerable Śāradvatīputra said this to Mañjuśrī the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, if the realm of sentient beings does not appear to diminish or fill up, because sentient beings are empty of sentient beings and because sentient beings are not sentient beings — then, having awakened to complete and perfect awakening, to whom does one teach the Dharma?"

When he had so spoken, Mañjuśrī the youthful said this to the venerable Śāradvatīputra: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, at the very time when sentient beings are utterly not apprehended, who is it that fully and completely awakens, and to whom is the Dharma to be taught? Why is that? Venerable Śāradvatīputra, it is because all phenomena are utterly beyond apprehension."

Then the Blessed One said this to Mañjuśrī the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, at the very time when all phenomena are utterly beyond apprehension, would one impute anything whatsoever as a sentient being? And further, Mañjuśrī, if someone were to ask you, 'How many sentient beings are there?' — what would you say in reply?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, to one who asked that, I would say: 'There are as many as there are buddha-qualities.'"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, if someone were further to ask you, 'To what does the realm of sentient beings belong?' — what would you say in reply?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, to one who asked that, I would say: 'It belongs to the same domain as birthlessness and inconceivability.'"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, if someone were to ask you, 'In what does the realm of sentient beings abide?' — what would you say in reply?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, to one who asked that, I would say: 'The realm of sentient beings abides in whatever the realm of birthlessness abides in.'"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, when you cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom, in what do you abide while cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, when I cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom, I cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom by abiding in nothing whatsoever."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, if one abides in nothing, what is there to cultivate as the Perfection of Wisdom?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, that very non-abiding in anything at all — that itself is the cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, when you cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom, do your roots of virtue thereby increase or diminish?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Blessed One, at that time there is nothing whatsoever that would cause my roots of virtue to increase or diminish. Blessed One, if any phenomenon whatsoever were to increase or diminish, that would not be cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, know that whoever abides in view of some phenomenon increasing or some phenomenon diminishing — that is not cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, not abandoning the phenomena of ordinary beings and not appropriating the phenomena of buddhas — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Why so? Blessed One, it is because cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom means not abiding in any phenomenon whatsoever, since no phenomenon is apprehended as something to be abandoned or taken up.

Blessed One, not going to the faults of saṃsāra and not going to the qualities of nirvāṇa — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Why so? Blessed One, it is because when saṃsāra itself is not seen, what need is there to speak of the faults of saṃsāra? And when nirvāṇa itself is not apprehended, what need is there to speak of the qualities of nirvāṇa? Blessed One, having nothing to take up, to grasp, or to cast away with respect to any phenomenon

whatsoever — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, not apprehending decrease or increase in any phenomenon whatsoever — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Why so? Blessed One, it is because in what is unborn there is no decrease and no increase.

Blessed One, meditating in just that way — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, not producing the arising or the ceasing of any phenomenon whatsoever — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, not producing the diminishing or the expanding of any phenomenon whatsoever — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. And blessed One, meditating in just that way — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, furthermore, one neither aspires toward inconceivable phenomena nor aspires toward what is inferior. Blessed One, when both the object of aspiration and the one who aspires are themselves absent — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, meditating in that way is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

Blessed One, cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom means not dwelling near the thought 'these phenomena are superior, these phenomena are inferior,' and not apprehending those phenomena by which something would become superior or inferior. Thus a son of good family who strives in the practice of cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom apprehends no phenomenon at all. Blessed One, cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom means not conceiving of any phenomenon as superior or as inferior. Why so? Blessed One, it is because in what is unborn there is nothing whatsoever to be called superior or inferior. In suchness (tathatā), in the ultimate limit, and with respect to all phenomena, there is likewise no superior and no inferior. Blessed One, meditating in that way is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the youthful bodhisattva: "Mañjuśrī, are not the phenomena of buddhas superior?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, the phenomena of buddhas are superior — because they cannot be grasped. Blessed One, did the Tathāgata awaken to full and perfect buddhahood with all phenomena being empty?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, it is just so."

The Tathāgata awakened to full and perfect buddhahood with all phenomena being empty.

Mañjuśrī asked: "Blessed One, can emptiness be called superior or inferior?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, excellent, excellent! Mañjuśrī, it is just so — exactly as you have said. Mañjuśrī, are not the phenomena of buddhas unsurpassed?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "It is so, Blessed One. The phenomena of buddhas are indeed unsurpassed. Why? Because, Blessed One, in them there is not even the slightest phenomenon to be found or apprehended. For that very reason, the phenomena of buddhas are unsurpassed.

"Furthermore, Blessed One, one who neither strives to achieve the phenomena of buddhas, nor strives to abandon the phenomena of ordinary beings, who neither tames nor grasps at the phenomena of buddhas — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Furthermore, Blessed One, one who is without conceptual intention toward any phenomenon whatsoever and who does not cognize anything distinctly — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, do you then have no conceptual intention toward the phenomena of buddhas?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, if I were to see the phenomena of buddhas as completely established, then I would indeed have conceptual intention toward the phenomena of buddhas. Blessed One, to think 'these are the phenomena of cultivation for the Perfection of Wisdom' — calling them phenomena of ordinary beings, phenomena of those in training, phenomena of those beyond training, phenomena of pratyekabuddhas, or phenomena of fully and perfectly awakened buddhas — is to abide in proximity to conceptuality with respect to phenomena. That is not how I remain. Why? Because a son of good family (kulaputra) who strives in the practice of cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom does not apprehend even those very phenomena themselves. The nature of reality that transcends all extremes is such that one neither apprehends those phenomena as phenomena of ordinary beings, nor speaks of them as phenomena of those in training, phenomena of those beyond training, phenomena of pratyekabuddhas, or phenomena of fully and perfectly awakened buddhas — for those phenomena are not apprehended and are not genuinely seen. Blessed One, meditating in that way is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Furthermore, Blessed One, a son of good family who strives in the practice of cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom does not conceive of anything as 'this is the desire realm,' 'this is the form realm,' 'this is the formless realm,' and so on, up to and including 'this is the element of cessation.' Why? Because, Blessed One, one who meditates thus does not see any phenomenon whatsoever that has the nature of cessation. Blessed One, meditating in that way should be understood as cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Furthermore, Blessed One, one who neither benefits nor harms any phenomenon whatsoever — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Blessed One, cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom neither bestows the phenomena of buddhas nor cuts off the phenomena of ordinary beings. Blessed One, one who neither suppresses the phenomena of ordinary beings nor attains the phenomena of buddhas — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the youthful bodhisattva: "Mañjuśrī, it is excellent, excellent that you have taught such a profound Dharma as this. Mañjuśrī, you have taught this to the bodhisattvas, the great beings, and

to those of the śrāvaka vehicle who are afflicted with manifest pride, and to those of the bodhisattva vehicle who are object-focused, so that they may understand correctly, just as things are. This seal has been set."

"Mañjuśrī, whatever sons of good family or daughters of good family hear this teaching of the profound Perfection of Wisdom and do not become afraid, do not become timid, and do not tremble — they are not ones who have served a single buddha, nor ones who have planted roots of virtue under a single buddha."

When this was said, Mañjuśrī, the youthful bodhisattva, spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I am confident to teach the Perfection of Wisdom extensively."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, be confident."

Mañjuśrī then said: "Blessed One, that in which one perceives no abiding of any phenomenon in anything, and likewise perceives no non-abiding — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Why is that? Because all phenomena are perceived as non-abiding. Blessed One, that in which one does not dwell near anything on account of superimposing apprehension upon any phenomenon —

that, I understand, is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Why is that? Blessed One, it is because all phenomena are without object. Blessed One, to cultivate in that way is to cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Blessed One, furthermore, that in which the phenomena of buddhas do not become manifest — to say nothing of the phenomena of pratyekabuddhas, and if even the phenomena of śrāvakas do not become manifest, to say nothing of the phenomena of ordinary beings — that I regard as cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Blessed One, furthermore, that cultivation in reliance upon which, even with respect to the inconceivable phenomena of buddhas, one does not conceptualize them as 'the inconceivable phenomena of buddhas' — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, this cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom I regard as the non-conceptualization of all phenomena by the bodhisattvas, the great beings.

"Blessed One, furthermore, that cultivation in reliance upon which one sees all phenomena as the phenomena of buddhas without there being any seeing, and sees all phenomena as inconceivable phenomena — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Whatever sons of good family or daughters of good family hear this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom and do not become afraid, do not become timid, and do not tremble — they will have served many hundreds of thousands of buddhas.

"Blessed One, furthermore, that in which one does not truly perceive any phenomenon at all as either defiled or purified — that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, to cultivate in that way is to cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Blessed One, this cultivation of the Perfection of Wisdom makes no distinction whatsoever between ordinary beings, śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. Blessed One, that is cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom."

Then the Blessed One spoke to Mañjuśrī, the youthful bodhisattva: "Mañjuśrī, how many Tathāgatas have you served?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, as many as the moments of cessation of the mind and mental factors of an illusory person — that many. Blessed One, I have served that many Tathāgatas."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, have you not entered into the phenomena of buddhas?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Blessed One, is there anything whatsoever that can be apprehended as a phenomenon one has genuinely entered upon in entering into the phenomena of buddhas?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, then in whom do those phenomena of buddhas exist?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, even in the Blessed One himself, even the name of what is called 'the phenomena of buddhas' does not exist and is not apprehended — so what need is there to speak of their existing in others?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, have you attained non-attachment?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, if I myself am non-attachment itself, how could I attain non-attachment?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, are you sitting at the seat of awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "If the ultimate limit were to be seized, then — since even the Blessed One himself has not entered into the seat of awakening — how could I be said to be there?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, whose word is what is called 'the ultimate limit'?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, what is called 'the ultimate limit' is a word belonging to the perishable collection."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, with what in mind do you say that?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, that perishable collection does not exist. Because the perishable collection does not exist, it does not pass over. And that which is free from passing over also does not exist. For that reason, this collection is not a perishable collection."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra (Śāriputra) said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, those bodhisattvas, great beings, who hear this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — those ones are certain to attain awakening."

Then the bodhisattva and great being Maitreya said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, those bodhisattvas, great beings, who hear this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — those ones have drawn near to awakening. And why? Because, Blessed One, the very comprehension of those phenomena is supreme awakening."

Then the youthful bodhisattva Mañjuśrī said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, those bodhisattvas, great beings, who hear this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — those ones I would regard as buddhas themselves. And why? Because, Blessed One, what is called 'buddha' is, in the ultimate sense, a word for the non-arising of birth."

Then the sister Anāpalambhā (Aparimitā) said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, those bodhisattvas, great beings, who hear this Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — those ones will not fixate superiorly upon the phenomena of ordinary beings, the phenomena of śrāvakas, the phenomena of pratyekabuddhas, or the phenomena of perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. And why? Because, Blessed One, since all phenomena do not exist, they are not apprehended; for that reason, there is no apprehension of them."

Then the Blessed One said to the venerable Śāradvatīputra: "Śāradvatīputra, so it is. Śāradvatīputra, so it is indeed. Sons of good family and daughters of good family who hear this teaching of the profound Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — those ones are certain to attain awakening. Śāradvatīputra, sons of good family and

daughters of good family who hear this teaching of the profound Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful, and who receive it upon the crown of their heads — you should know that those ones abide on the stage of non-return. Śāradvatīputra, those who hear this teaching of the profound Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — they will become supreme patrons, great patrons, and supremely excellent patrons. Śāradvatīputra, they will come to possess perfect moral discipline; they will become the foremost among those endowed with moral discipline; they will become supremely excellent in moral discipline; and through the virtue of moral discipline they will find the path. Śāradvatīputra, those who hear this teaching of the profound

Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — they will come to possess the highest patience, the highest diligence, the highest meditative concentration, and the highest wisdom beyond compare. Śāradvatīputra, those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who hear this teaching of the profound Perfection of Wisdom, have faith in it, and do not become frightened, terrified, or fearful — they will come to possess, all the way to its culmination, the primordial wisdom of omniscience endowed with the highest of all aspects."

Then the Blessed One spoke these further words to Mañjuśrī, the Prince of the Dharma: "Mañjuśrī, seeing what significance is it that you do not wish to fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, if I were to enter upon awakening, then in that case, were I to wish to fully and completely awaken, I would not be aspiring toward awakening. Blessed One, I do not aspire toward awakening. And why is that? Blessed One, what Mañjuśrī, the Prince of the Dharma, is — that itself is awakening."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said to Mañjuśrī, the Prince of the Dharma: "Excellent, Mañjuśrī! Excellent! You teach a profound matter, profound indeed. For you have in the past served the former Victors and long practiced the holy life without apprehending anything."

Mañjuśrī said: "Blessed One, if I practice without apprehending, that would amount to obtaining a dharma."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One said to Mañjuśrī, the Prince of the Dharma: "Mañjuśrī, do you see these excellent hearers of mine?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, I see them."

The Blessed One said: "How and in what manner do you see them?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, I see them in the way one does not see an ordinary person, does not see one in training, and does not see one beyond training — there is neither a seeing nor a non-seeing. Thus I see them: neither seeing many nor seeing few, neither seeing those who are tamed nor seeing those who are untamed."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra said to Mañjuśrī, the Prince of the Dharma: "Mañjuśrī, if you see those of the śrāvaka vehicle in that way, how do you see those of the vehicle of the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I do not perceive even the dharma called 'bodhisattva.' I do not perceive the dharma called 'one who has entered upon awakening.' I do not perceive the dharma called 'one who practices for the sake of awakening.'

"I do not perceive even the dharma called 'perfectly and completely awakened.' Venerable Śāradvatīputra, that is how I see those of the vehicle of the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, how do you see the Tathāgata?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, set down the great elephant. Do not stir the great elephant."

When he had spoken these words, the venerable Śāradvatīputra said this to Mañjuśrī, the Youthful: "Mañjuśrī, whose word is the word 'buddha'?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, whose word is the word 'self'?"

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, it is like this: the word 'self' is the word for that which is unborn."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, that is so. Just as the word 'self' is the word for what is unborn, so too the word 'buddha' is the word for that same thing. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, it is also like this: the word 'buddha' is the word for that which has no ground. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the word 'buddha' is difficult to understand through words. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, if even a word is difficult to examine as 'this is a word,' what need is there to speak of the word 'buddha'? Venerable Śāradvatīputra, one who knows that the word 'buddha' is the word for what has no ground speaks of something that is not fully established, not arisen, and not ceasing — something that is not endowed with any dharma whatsoever, that has no ground at all, is inseparable from groundlessness, and is without ground. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, it is like this: the word 'buddha' is the word for that. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, one who wishes to seek the Tathāgata should seek the self. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the word 'self' is the word that points to buddha — for just as the self is utterly absent and unapprehendable, so too the buddha is utterly absent and unapprehendable. Just as the dharma called 'self' is not expressed by anything whatsoever as a word, so too the buddha is not expressed by any dharma whatsoever as a word. That for which there is no enumeration — that is called buddha. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the word that points to the ground of what is called 'self' is not easy to understand.

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, in the same way, the word that points to the ground of what is called 'buddha' is also not easy to understand."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, Mañjuśrī the Youthful does not show the teaching in a way suited to one who is a beginner."

When he had said this, Mañjuśrī the Youthful said to the venerable Śāradvatīputra: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I do not show any dharma of a kind that could be understood even by one who has accomplished the state of arhat. Nor do I show any teaching of a kind that could be understood by anyone at all. Why is that? Because awakening has not been known by anyone, has not been fully understood by anyone, has not been fully and perfectly realized by anyone, has not been seen, not been heard, not been recollected, not been generated, not been blocked, not been spoken, and not been taught by anyone. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, awakening is like that, and awakening is not a thing. Why? Because there is nothing whatsoever to be perfectly and completely awakened by means of awakening, and awakening itself is not perfectly and completely awakened by awakening."

Śāradvatīputra said:

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, did the Blessed One become fully and perfectly awakened by means of the dharmadhātu itself?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, that is not so. Why? Because, venerable Śāradvatīputra, the dharmadhātu itself is the Blessed One. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, if the Blessed One were to have become fully and perfectly awakened by means of the dharmadhātu, that would contradict the very sphere that is without arising. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, that dharmadhātu itself is awakening. Why? Because the dharmadhātu is without sentient beings. The statement 'all phenomena are without essential nature' is a synonym for awakening, and it falls within the enumeration of the dharmadhātu. Why? Because all phenomena, as the domain of a buddha, are without distinction.

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, 'without distinction' means without discernment. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, 'without discernment' means incapable of being known through consciousness — incapable of being discerned as conditioned, and equally incapable of being discerned as unconditioned. Since there is no discernment whatsoever in it, it is therefore called 'without discernment.'

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are without discernment. Why? Because there is no arising of a basis in which all phenomena could come to be discerned. Those who have entered into the unimpeded have entered into the inconceivable. Those who have entered into the inconceivable have entered into the true. Why? Because, venerable Śāradvatīputra, 'the true' means that which has no basis to be divided. Those who are endowed with the inconceivable do not go to the higher realms, do not go to the lower realms, and do not go to nirvāṇa. Why? Because the inconceivable does not abide in relation to going or not going — from the most basic level right through to nirvāṇa, it does not abide in relation to going or not going.

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, those who abide in the four root transgressions (pārājikas) are abiding in that which is without root. Why? Because, venerable Śāradvatīputra, in what is without arising there is nothing that can be called a root or a summit. The phrase 'a monk without root' is a synonym for 'a monk of non-abiding.' The phrase 'one who has given rise to conflict' is a synonym for the phrase 'one who superimposes excessively.' Venerable Śāradvatīputra, one who practices with excessive superimposition becomes a worthy recipient of offerings in the world. Why? Because it is upon the equal that such superimposition has been imposed.

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, a monk who has faith is not a worthy recipient of what is given out of faith. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, a monk who is without faith is a worthy recipient of what is given out of faith. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, a monk who is fit is not a worthy recipient of what is given out of faith. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, a monk who is not fit is a worthy recipient of what is given out of faith. A monk who has not destroyed moral discipline is called an arhat whose defilements are exhausted."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, with what in mind do you say such things?"

Mañjuśrī said: "That very equanimity which does not truly destroy equanimity — that itself is moral discipline. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, with that in mind I said: 'a monk who has not destroyed moral discipline is called an arhat whose defilements are exhausted.' Venerable Śāradvatīputra, 'one who has not passed beyond fear' is a synonym for 'an arhat whose defilements are exhausted.'"

Śāradvatīputra said:

Mañjuśrī said: "When there is not even the slightest fear in that, what is there to overcome?"

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, whose words are 'one who has patience with the unborn'?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, one who has not produced even the slightest phenomenon — that one is called 'one who has patience with the unborn.'"

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, whose words are 'a monk who is untamed'?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, 'a monk who is untamed' is a synonym for 'an arhat whose defilements are exhausted.' Why is that? Because the untamed is tamed, and the tamed is untamed. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, with that in mind I said: 'a monk who is untamed is a synonym for an arhat whose defilements are exhausted.' Venerable Śāradvatīputra, the words 'one who acts with an elevated mind' are a synonym for an ordinary person."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Mañjuśrī, with what in mind do you say such things?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, it is because one thereby elevates further."

When this was said, the venerable Śāradvatīputra spoke thus to youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, it is excellent, excellent, that you have spoken in just that way about an arhat whose defilements are exhausted."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, it is indeed so — just as it was said, so it is. My defilements are exhausted, yet I am not an arhat. Why is that? Venerable Śāradvatīputra, it is because my aspiration has been exhausted at the level of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, for this reason my defilements are exhausted, yet I am not an arhat."

Then the Blessed One spoke thus to youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, is there a way in which a bodhisattva, a great being, seated at the seat of awakening, would lack the good fortune to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, genuine, complete awakening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, there is indeed a way in which a bodhisattva, a great being, seated at the seat of awakening, would lack the good fortune to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, genuine, complete awakening. Why is that? Because in awakening there is not even the slightest phenomenon to be found or apprehended — therefore it is called unsurpassed, genuine, complete awakening. Moreover, that awakening itself is unborn. In

this there is no one who is at the seat of awakening, no one who fully and perfectly awakens, no one by whom awakening is fully and perfectly attained, no awakening that is fully and perfectly attained, and no one who rises from the seat of awakening — none of these is found or apprehended. Blessed One, for this reason a bodhisattva, a great being, seated at the seat of awakening, lacks the good fortune to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, genuine, complete awakening."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, whose words are 'awakening'?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, what is called 'awakening' is a synonym for the five uninterrupted states. Why is that? Blessed One, it is because those very five uninterrupted states, by virtue of nothing being truly existent, are themselves the intrinsic nature of awakening.

For that reason, awakening itself is the intrinsic nature of the five uninterrupted states. Yet the realization of those uninterrupted states is not awakening, nor is the direct perception of all phenomena awakening. Why is that? All phenomena are not truly and directly perceptible, for none of them has been fully and perfectly realized, from the beginning through not having been seen, heard, sought, or understood. That very fact is awakening. Yet, Blessed One, those with arrogant presumption have placed it within a range extending from the moment of complete and perfect buddhahood to the moment of direct perception.

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, do you think of it this way: 'The Tathāgata is my Tathāgata'?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, it is not so. Why is that? Blessed One, it is because I do not think of it as 'The Tathāgata is my Tathāgata.' Why is that? Blessed One, suchness is itself the Tathāgata, and suchness does not cognize the Tathāgata, nor does the Tathāgata cognize suchness. Why is that? Blessed One, in ultimate truth, suchness has no true existence, and the Tathāgata likewise has no true existence. Therefore, Blessed One, I do not think of it as 'The Tathāgata is my Tathāgata.' Blessed One, the very designation 'Tathāgata' is a mere name. Then what kind of Tathāgata could it be that I would think of as 'The Tathāgata is my Tathāgata'?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, do you have doubts about the Tathāgata?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, it is not so. Blessed One, if there were something truly and completely established as the Tathāgata, whether the Tathāgata having appeared or the Tathāgata having passed into complete nirvāṇa, then I would have doubt about that. But as it is, I do not."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, do you not believe that the Tathāgata has appeared?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, if there were an arising in the dharmadhātu, then I would think 'The Tathāgata has appeared.' "

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, do you not believe that buddhas, Blessed Ones, as numerous as the grains of sand along the Ganges river, have passed into complete nirvāṇa?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, are not all buddhas, Blessed Ones, a single domain within the inconceivable?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, that is so. All buddhas, Blessed Ones, are a single domain within the inconceivable."

Mañjuśrī asked: "Blessed One, is it so that they abide thus?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, it is so."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, for that reason those buddhas, Blessed Ones, as numerous as the grains of sand along the Ganges, have not passed into complete nirvāṇa. Why is that? Blessed One, because all buddhas, Blessed Ones, are a single domain within the inconceivable, and the inconceivable itself neither arises nor ceases."

The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, Blessed One, when you yourself attained perfect and complete awakening, those who at that time had not yet appeared and would thereafter become Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas — they too, in just the same way, are none other than perfectly and completely awakened. Why is that? Because within the inconceivable there is no past, no future, and no present. Therefore, Blessed One, those who conceive of a Tathāgata as having been born, all the way through to his passing into complete nirvāṇa — their dwelling in the world is a delusion. Blessed One, such people cause a break in the continuity of worldly existence."

When this was said, the Blessed One declared to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, for that reason you should proclaim this inconceivable, unthinkable,

incomprehensible, thought-transcending quality of the Tathāgata before Tathāgatas, before bodhisattvas, great beings who have reached the stage of non-returning, and before arhats whose defilements are exhausted. Why? Because upon hearing it, they will neither praise it nor reject it. Why is that? Because this is inconceivable, unthinkable, and incomprehensible."

Mañjuśrī asked: "Blessed One, if all phenomena are inconceivable and unthinkable, who would praise or reject them?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, just as the Tathāgata is incomprehensible, are ordinary beings likewise incomprehensible?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, ordinary beings too are likewise incomprehensible."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, that is so. Why? Because all thought is incomprehensible."

Mañjuśrī asked: "Blessed One, then why did you declare that just as the Tathāgata is incomprehensible, so too ordinary beings are incomprehensible? Is it not that ordinary beings themselves are also incomprehensible? Why? Because, Blessed One, all phenomena are incomprehensible. Blessed One, if certain people enter upon the path for the sake of nirvāṇa, those people will come to grief. Why? Because the inconceivable itself is nirvāṇa, Blessed One, and therefore there is no distinction between the inconceivable and nirvāṇa. Blessed One, those who say, 'These are the phenomena of ordinary beings, and these are the phenomena of noble ones' — to them one should first say: 'Attend upon spiritual friends.' Only after that will they come to understand what are the phenomena of ordinary beings and what are the phenomena of noble ones. This is what should be said to them."

When this was said, the Blessed One declared to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, do you hold the Tathāgata to be the supreme among all sentient beings?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, if there were something here that were fully established as a sentient being, then I would hold the Tathāgata to be supreme among all sentient beings. But, Blessed One —"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, do you hold the Tathāgata to be endowed with the quality of inconceivability?"

Mañjuśrī replied:

"Blessed One, if there were here some phenomenon that were of the nature of conceivable things, then I would hold the Tathāgata to be endowed with the quality of inconceivability. But as it is, there is none."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, do you hold the view that these śrāvakas here have been tamed by the Tathāgata?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, if someone were capable of taming the inconceivable realm, then I would indeed hold that these śrāvakas have been tamed by the Tathāgata. Blessed One, the arising of a buddha neither benefits nor harms anyone, for the realm itself simply abides as it is, unmixed and unaltered — and that is precisely because it is the inconceivable realm. Within that realm, from śrāvakas all the way to ordinary beings, not one is to be apprehended as distinct."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, do you not hold the Tathāgata to be the unsurpassed field of merit?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, the Tathāgata is a field of merit because of the absence of any inherently existent thing, and it is for that reason that he is the unsurpassed field of merit. He is neither a field that is full nor a field that is empty, nor is he something that is not a field at all — and it is for that very reason that he is the unsurpassed field of merit. Blessed One, moreover, because no phenomenon in that field is or could be truly established, it is therefore a field of merit. Seeds planted in it neither increase nor diminish."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, from what do you reason when you say that seeds planted in that field neither increase nor diminish?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, that field is inconceivable, and it is for that very reason that it is a field of merit."

At that moment, through the power of the buddhas, the great earth trembled in six ways. Sixty-six thousand monks were liberated in mind from the defilements without remainder, through non-clinging. Seven hundred nuns, three hundred laymen, forty thousand laywomen, and sixty trillion gods of the desire realm all attained the pure and stainless eye of Dharma regarding phenomena.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his monastic robe over one shoulder, knelt on his right knee, and, joining his palms together in the direction of the Blessed One, he bowed and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what was the cause and what was the

condition for this great trembling that occurred throughout the world?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, this enumeration of Dharma called 'Revealing the Field of Merit' was also taught by the previous blessed buddhas in this very place. That was the cause and that was the condition for this trembling of the earth throughout the world."

Then the venerable Śāriputra spoke to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, Mañjuśrī is an inconceivable glory. Why so? Because whatever eloquence he possesses — every single instance of it — is itself inconceivable."

Thereupon the Blessed One declared to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, the words spoken by the monk Śāriputra are just so. Whatever eloquence belongs to the youthful Mañjuśrī — all of it without exception is inconceivable."

When this was said,

The youthful Mañjuśrī then said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the inconceivable cannot become the object of eloquence. If the inconceivable were to become the object of eloquence, it would thereby become conceivable. And as for something inconceivable that is not inconceivable — there is no such thing at all. Blessed One, all sounds are inconceivable, and the inconceivable itself is not sound. What is not sound, and what is neither not-sound nor otherwise, cannot be expressed."

The Blessed One then declared to Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, do you enter into the meditative absorption of the inconceivable?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, that is not so — I do not enter into the meditative absorption of the inconceivable. Why? Because, Blessed One, I myself am the meditative absorption of the inconceivable. Blessed One, if I were conceivable, then I would enter into the meditative absorption of the inconceivable. Blessed One, since what is called meditative absorption is itself inconceivable, beyond conceiving, and beyond being surveyed by thought — how could one enter into the meditative absorption of the inconceivable? Even so, Blessed One, in former times, when I was a beginner, I thought to myself: 'I will enter into the meditative absorption of the inconceivable.' But now, Blessed One, no such thought arises in me at all — no such notion that 'I am entering into the meditative absorption of the inconceivable.' Blessed One, it is like this: consider an archery master who, when he was a beginner still learning, thought to himself: 'I will strike the oxhair targets.' But once he has

become skilled at striking the hair, when he does strike the hair the thought no longer arises in him: 'I will strike the oxhair targets.' Rather, whenever he wishes to strike the hair, he strikes it without even trying. Blessed One, in just the same way, I formerly thought: 'I will enter into the meditative absorption of the inconceivable.' But now, whenever I have entered into that absorption and abide in it, I no longer think: 'I will again abide in this meditative absorption.' Why? Because at whatever time I abide in this meditative absorption, at that very time this meditative absorption is not something that can be designated."

Then the venerable Śāriputra spoke to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, when the youthful Mañjuśrī abides in this meditative absorption of the inconceivable, is his mind not distracted? Blessed One, is there another meditative absorption more peaceful than this meditative absorption of the inconceivable?"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, when you ask whether there is another meditative absorption more peaceful than this meditative absorption of the inconceivable — venerable Śāriputra, how do you know that this meditative absorption of the inconceivable is peaceful? Venerable Śāriputra, if this meditative absorption of the inconceivable existed and were an object of focus, then there would indeed be another meditative absorption more peaceful than this one."

Śāriputra said: "Mañjuśrī, does this meditative absorption of the inconceivable then not exist and not be an object of focus?"

Mañjuśrī said:

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Śāriputra, it is precisely this that makes it the meditative absorption of the inconceivable. Therefore this meditative absorption of the inconceivable does not exist and is not an object of focus. And yet, venerable Śāriputra, there is no one whatsoever who has not attained the meditative absorption of the inconceivable. Venerable Śāriputra, all sentient beings have attained the meditative absorption of the inconceivable. Why is that? Because all that is conceived is inconceivable, and whatever is inconceivable is the meditative absorption of the inconceivable. Therefore all sentient beings have attained this meditative absorption of the inconceivable."

This is the second and final fascicle.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the youthful bodhisattva: "Excellent, excellent, Mañjuśrī! You have well taught all these profound and deep matters. For thus, Mañjuśrī, you have served the Victors of

old, practicing the holy life of non-objectification for a very long time. Mañjuśrī, do you think that you speak thus because you abide in the Perfection of Wisdom?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, if I were to speak thus as one abiding in the Perfection of Wisdom, that would mean I spoke thus while abiding in an object of focus. It would mean I spoke thus while abiding in the perception of a self, all the way up to abiding in the perception of a thing. Therefore I do not speak thus as one abiding in the Perfection of Wisdom. And why is that? Blessed One, if the Perfection of Wisdom were to become a locus, or if there were something that is not a locus, then the Perfection of Wisdom would not be the Perfection of Wisdom. Blessed One, my locus is the locus of the Perfection of Wisdom — which is to say, a locus without abiding, without arising from anywhere, without occasion, without production. That being so, that locus is not the locus of any phenomenon whatsoever. Therefore that locus is the inconceivable locus: it is the locus of the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Blessed One, what is called the Perfection of Wisdom is precisely the non-arising of all phenomena — that is the Perfection of Wisdom. And what is called the Perfection of Wisdom is best expressed by the words 'the inconceivable basic space.' The inconceivable basic space is the basic space of non-arising. The basic space of non-arising is the dharmadhātu. The dharmadhātu is the basic space of utter non-origination. The basic space of utter non-origination is the inconceivable basic space. The inconceivable basic space is the basic space of self. The basic space of self is the basic space of the Perfection of Wisdom. Thus the basic space of the Perfection of Wisdom and the basic space of self are not two and are not to be made into two. Because these two are not two and are not to be divided into two, this is the inconceivable basic space. Because this is the inconceivable basic space, it is the basic space of non-arising. Because it is the basic space of non-arising, it is the dharmadhātu. Because it is the dharmadhātu, it is the basic space of utter non-origination. Because it is the basic space of utter non-origination, it is the inconceivable basic space."

Because this is the inconceivable basic space, it is the basic space of self. Because it is the basic space of self, it is the basic space of the Perfection of Wisdom. Because it is the basic space of the Perfection of Wisdom, it is the inconceivable basic space. Because this is the inconceivable basic space, it is the basic space of utter non-establishment. Whatever is utterly non-established does not exist. Whatever does not exist cannot be destroyed.

Whatever cannot be destroyed is inconceivable. Thus the basic space of the Tathāgata and this basic space of self are not two and are not to be divided into two.

As for the Blessed One's declaration that "to meditate on self is to meditate on the Perfection of Wisdom" — why is this so? Blessed One, it is because the term "Perfection of Wisdom" is a synonym for "basic space of self." And why is that? Because whoever seeks the basic space of self is seeking the basic space free from attachment. And whoever seeks the very state free from attachment is seeking no phenomenon whatsoever — and why is that? Because the inconceivable primordial wisdom is the primordial wisdom of a buddha, and the absence of knowing with respect to any phenomenon whatsoever is the primordial wisdom of a buddha.

And why is that? Because that primordial wisdom does not exist in the ultimate sense. How could something that does not exist ultimately turn the wheel of Dharma? When that primordial wisdom does not exist ultimately, it is free from attachment. When it is free from attachment, it is without any thing. When it is without any thing, it is without an object. When it is without an object, it does not abide. When it does not abide, it has no support. When it has no support, it has not been produced, it has not been obtained, and it will not arise.

And why is that? Because that primordial wisdom is not compounded by qualities, nor is it compounded by what is not qualities. And why is that? Because that primordial wisdom is inconceivable — and therefore how could it be indicated as either quality or non-quality? Because that primordial wisdom is inconceivable, it is beyond thought. Whoever understands it thus knows the primordial wisdom of a buddha in the mode of non-apprehension. Through that primordial wisdom, there is no full awakening to or knowing of any phenomenon whatsoever. That primordial wisdom has not come from a prior limit or a later limit. That primordial wisdom was not born before, nor was it unborn before — for because it was not unborn, whatever is not born will not cease and will not be cut off. There is no other primordial wisdom comparable to that primordial wisdom, and therefore that primordial wisdom is inconceivable and without equal. That primordial wisdom is without a beginning, middle, or end being apprehended, and therefore that primordial wisdom is like space. In that primordial wisdom, neither equality nor inequality is apprehended, and therefore that primordial wisdom is the equal of the unequal. In that primordial wisdom, no other primordial wisdom comparable to

it is apprehended,

and therefore that primordial wisdom is without equal.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful: "Mañjuśrī, has this primordial wisdom not been altered?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, this primordial wisdom has not been made, and therefore it has not been altered. Blessed One, consider, for example, an unstamped kārṣāpaṇa coin — it belongs to the class of what is neither altered nor unaltered. Blessed One, in the same way, this primordial wisdom too has not been made, not been accomplished, not been produced, not arisen, and not ceased — and therefore it has not been altered."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful: "Mañjuśrī, who would delight in this teaching that presents the primordial wisdom of the Tathāgata?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, those who neither possess the characteristics of saṃsāra nor possess the characteristics of complete nirvāṇa, those who have not been moved away from the view of the transitory collection, and those who have not exhausted attachment, aversion, and delusion — they would delight in it. Why so? Because what has not been exhausted will not become exhausted and will not come to be completely exhausted. Those who have neither passed beyond saṃsāra nor fall into the category of saṃsāra, and those who are neither devoid of the path nor produce any perception of a path — they would seek the meaning of this teaching."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful: "Excellent! Excellent! Mañjuśrī, you have spoken these words well."

Then at that time the venerable Mahākāśyapa said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, in a future time will there come to be any who will listen to, delight in, seek to know fully, and uphold this profound teaching on discipline and this profound Perfection of Wisdom?"

When that was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Mahākāśyapa: "Kāśyapa, even within this very assembly there are monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen who in a future time will listen to, delight in, fully come to know, and uphold this profound teaching on discipline and this profound Perfection of Wisdom. Kāśyapa, consider, for example, a householder or the son of a householder who loses a hundred thousand precious jewels —

he would become pained and mentally distressed. If he were to find them again, joy and mental ease would arise in him, and his mind would be free of all entangling preoccupation. Kāśyapa, in the same way, those monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen, not having heard that this profound Perfection of Wisdom was unborn, has not arisen, and is by its very nature completely passed beyond sorrow, from the beginning down to the absence of inherent existence — they would think to themselves: 'We have not heard this, that this profound Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, has not arisen, and by its very nature is completely passed beyond sorrow, from the beginning down to the absence of inherent existence.' Then, when at another time they do come to hear it, joy, happiness, and gladness will arise in them, and their minds will be free of all entangling preoccupation. They will speak these very words: 'By hearing today that this profound Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, has not arisen, and is without inherent existence, we have seen the buddhas and have also attended upon the Tathāgatas.' Kāśyapa, consider this —

Consider this analogy: the gods of the Thirty-Three, upon seeing that the grove of the Pāricchataka tree has budded, think to themselves, "Before long, all the blossoms of this Pāricchataka will come into full flower," and they become glad and joyful. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, when monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen hear this — that the profound Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, has not arisen, and is without inherent existence — they too will become glad and joyful. Know, Kāśyapa, that those who in a future time will hear this — that the profound Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, has not arisen, and is without inherent existence — and who will become glad and joyful, are dwelling here in this very assembly of mine. Know also, Kāśyapa, that those who in a future time will become glad and joyful: by that very gladness and that joy, before long all the blossoms of the Dharma of the buddhas will burst into full flower — know that every blossom will bloom. Kāśyapa, understand that whoever, in the future time, will dwell in and practice this — that the profound Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, has not arisen, and is without inherent existence, down to the present — even after Tathāgatas of the past have passed away, that too, Kāśyapa, should be understood as the blessing of the buddhas and the power of the buddhas. Therefore, Kāśyapa, whoever hears this — that the profound Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, has not arisen, and is without inherent existence — and rejoices in it: Kāśyapa, for them this is not the first time they have heard it. Consider this, Kāśyapa: just as a jeweler, upon seeing a precious jewel, feels joy — one should know that this is not the jeweler seeing that

precious jewel for the very first time, but that he has been seeing precious jewels continuously from before. In the same way, Kāśyapa, whoever upon hearing this — that the profound Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, has not arisen, and is without inherent existence — becomes glad, joyful, pleased, delighted, and mentally at ease: Kāśyapa, for them this is not the first time they have heard it. They will say the following: "Speak to us once more that very teaching which Mañjuśrī, Prince of Dharma, set forth — from 'unborn' through 'without inherent existence' and 'has not arisen.'" This is because they have previously and continuously paid homage and attended upon Mañjuśrī, Prince of Dharma. Consider this further analogy, Kāśyapa: a certain person has traveled to some village, town, settlement, or district for various purposes. Then at another time, someone goes to that person and, singing the praises of that city, describes the delightful park, the delightful countryside, the delightful ponds, the delightful pleasure gardens, the delightful springs, pools, and lakes, the delightful flowers and fruits. When the first person hears these praises, he feels joy and mental ease arises in him, and he repeatedly says, "Come now, repeat those very words, good sir!" — from this it will be understood that that person had previously himself experienced that city, its delightful park, its delightful countryside, its delightful ponds, its delightful pleasure gardens, its delightful springs, pools, and lakes, its delightful flowers and fruits. Why? Because upon hearing this, great gladness and joy arose in him, and pleasure, delight, and

mental ease arose in him. In the same way, Kāśyapa, those who have attended upon Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, who have gone to him again and again and made inquiry of him — when they hear this deep Perfection of Wisdom, from its unborn and unarisen nature to its very absence of things, they will be filled with great joy and delight, generating joy and gladness in abundance, and will say again and again words such as these: "This very Perfection of Wisdom, taught in this way — from the unborn and unarisen to the very absence of things — I wish to hear more and more of it." When he had spoken thus, the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, are those very appearances, signs, and marks of the sons and daughters of good family who will arise in a future time — are those the ones the Blessed One has declared?" The Blessed One declared: "Kāśyapa, it is just as you have said. Those appearances, signs, and marks of the sons and daughters of good family who will arise in the future — those are precisely what I have now taught."

Then Mañjuśrī in his youthful form addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this Dharma is without appearance and without sign. And since the Perfection of Wisdom too is without appearance from beginning to end and without mark, what sort of appearance, sign, or mark could there be? Since the Dharma the Blessed One has taught is likewise without appearance, without sign, and without mark, how, Blessed One, does one teach what is without appearance, without sign, and without mark?" When this was asked, the Blessed One spoke thus to Mañjuśrī in his youthful form:

"Mañjuśrī, when this deep Perfection of Wisdom — utterly unborn and free of any thing — is being taught, those who proceed from faith all the way to complete mastery: it is precisely they who are the appearances, signs, and marks of those sons and daughters of good family. Mañjuśrī, wherever the Perfection of Wisdom is taught, one should regard all the qualities of a buddha as being taught there. One should regard the inconceivable as being taught there. Mañjuśrī, in former times when I was engaged in the bodhisattva's conduct, I perfectly accomplished wholesome roots — those very wholesome roots by which I fully and completely awakened to unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to perfectly accomplish such wholesome roots should listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, take faith in it, write it out, hold it, read it, memorize it by receiving its transmission, recite it aloud, chant it word by word, master it completely, attend to it properly in mind, and meditate upon it — and should make offerings to it with flowers, incense, perfume, garlands, unguents, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, pennants, triumph banners, lamps, and the like, to the utmost of one's ability and capacity. One should also pay homage to it. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to pass beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Mañjuśrī, any son or daughter of good family who wishes to hear in such a way as to enter the stage of irreversibility should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it."

"Mañjuśrī, any son or daughter of good family who wishes to gain conviction that all phenomena whatsoever are equal in being unborn should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Mañjuśrī, any son or daughter of good family who wishes to fully and perfectly awaken to all the qualities of a buddha should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Mañjuśrī,

any son or daughter of good family who wishes to gain conviction in this teaching, so deeply and thoroughly set forth, that all phenomena have been fully and perfectly awakened to by the Tathāgata, should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Why is that? Because there is absolutely nothing — no agent of full and perfect awakening, no one by whom full and perfect awakening is achieved, and no phenomenon by which full and perfect awakening is to be achieved — since none of these can be apprehended. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to comprehend and gain conviction in this very meaning should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to gain conviction in the teaching that there is no phenomenon whatsoever that is not awakening should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to be free from conceptuality with regard to all phenomena should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Why is that? Because the Perfection of Wisdom does not analyze, generate, or reveal the thorough accomplishment of any phenomenon. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to enter into the understanding that all phenomena are neither defiled nor purified should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to gain conviction and enter into the understanding that all phenomena are neither past, nor future, nor presently arisen should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Why is that? Mañjuśrī, because non-arising is neither past, nor future, nor presently arisen. Why is that? Mañjuśrī, because all phenomena rest upon non-arising. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to comprehend all such phenomena without doubt should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Mañjuśrī, any son or daughter of good family who wishes to hear, comprehend, gain conviction in, and enter into the wheel of Dharma that is turned in twelve aspects by being spoken three times should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to pervade all sentient beings with loving-kindness, yet also wishes to abide in no fixed notion of them as sentient beings, and who wishes to be without conflict with the entire world while yet wishing to comprehend the entire world as beyond apprehension, should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying

homage to it. Any son or daughter of good family who wishes to comprehend all phenomena through and through as non-arising should likewise listen to this very Perfection of Wisdom, and so on through paying homage to it."

A daughter of good family, too, should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom through the approach of non-apprehension.

Then Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what are the qualities of the Perfection of Wisdom that is without qualities, and what are its benefits?"

"Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom is without any capacity, it does not arouse anything, it does not cause any terror, it grasps at no phenomenon, it relinquishes nothing, it is without agitation, and it is without activity. The Perfection of Wisdom is not a knowing of essential nature, it is not a seeing of that essential nature, it confers no phenomenon, it is not in conflict with any phenomenon, and it makes no distinction among phenomena. Blessed One, what then are the qualities of the Perfection of Wisdom, and what are its benefits?

"Blessed One, the Perfection of Wisdom does not unify all phenomena into one, nor does it differentiate all phenomena into many. It has not been done, it will not be done, it is inexhaustible, and it does not cause destruction. It does not confer, and does not diminish, the phenomena of ordinary beings, the phenomena of arhats, the phenomena of bodhisattvas, or the phenomena of buddhas. It does not cause the taking up of saṃsāra, nor the abandonment of nirvāṇa. It does not confer the phenomena of buddhas, nor does it destroy them. It is not something to be thought, nor is it something unthinkable. It is without activity and without destruction. With respect to all phenomena, it neither produces nor ceases them. It does not make them annihilated or permanent. It does not make them come or go. It does not make them solitary or non-solitary. It does not make them dual or non-dual. Such being the case, what are the qualities and benefits of the Perfection of Wisdom?"

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful: "Mañjuśrī, everything from 'without things' through 'without activity' — all of this should be understood as the qualities of this very Perfection of Wisdom.

"Moreover, Mañjuśrī, any bodhisattva, a great being, who wishes to train in the meditative absorption of a bodhisattva, who wishes to accomplish the meditative absorption of a bodhisattva, who wishes — abiding in that

absorption — to behold all buddhas, the Blessed Ones, and to see their buddha-fields as well, and to know their names, and to make the highest offering to them, and to enter into the Dharma they teach, and to do so not in the manner of training through mere aspiration — such a one should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom.

Then Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful, addressed the Blessed One once more: "Blessed One, why is this called the Perfection of Wisdom?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, it is called the Perfection of Wisdom because it is without arising and without cessation — because from the very beginning it is at peace, without production, and without activity, all the way through to being without things. That which is without things: that is the Perfection of Wisdom.

"Therefore, Mañjuśrī, bodhisattvas, great beings, should understand how to cultivate the Perfection of Wisdom. That in which all phenomena are not the domain of experience — that is precisely the domain of bodhisattvas, great beings."

One who engages in this is called a bodhisattva, a great being, who has entered the domain of activity. That is to say: this very thing that is not the domain of any vehicle — that is precisely the domain of activity. And why? Because this domain is uncreated; therefore it is called "not the domain of activity."

Then Mañjuśrī, Ever-Youthful, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, by cultivating what would a bodhisattva, a great being, swiftly come to perfectly and completely awaken to unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening?"

When he had spoken, the Blessed One declared to Mañjuśrī, Ever-Youthful: "Mañjuśrī, by cultivating the Perfection of Wisdom, a bodhisattva, a great being, will swiftly come to perfectly and completely awaken to unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening. Mañjuśrī, there is a meditative absorption called the Single Array. By cultivating that absorption, a bodhisattva, a great being, will swiftly come to perfectly and completely awaken to unsurpassable, perfect, and complete awakening."

When he had declared this, Mañjuśrī, Ever-Youthful, addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, how should a bodhisattva, a great being, enter into the meditative absorption of the Single Array? And why is it called

the meditative absorption of the Single Array?"

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, the expression 'Single Array' is a synonym for non-arising. A son or daughter of good family who wishes to enter into the meditative absorption of the Single Array must at the very outset thoroughly inquire into the Perfection of Wisdom; only after that will they enter into the meditative absorption of the Single Array. And why? Mañjuśrī, non-arising is undisturbed — it cannot be disturbed, it is not to be disturbed, it is inconceivable, it cannot be conceived, it is beyond the scope of thought.

"Mañjuśrī, a son or daughter of good family who wishes to enter into the meditative absorption of the Single Array should resort to secluded dwelling-places, delight in non-busyness, and, setting aside all signs from the mind, sit in cross-legged posture. Seated there, they should bring to mind one single Tathāgata by way of non-objectification. They should also bring all phenomena to mind. They should take up the name of whichever Tathāgata they are bringing to mind. Having heard that name and held it as the object, they should sit with their gaze directed toward the quarter in which that Tathāgata dwells, facing that direction, and bring him to mind. When one has thus brought that very Tathāgata to mind, through that act of bringing to mind all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones — of the past, the future, and the present — will be brought to mind. And why? Because the Tathāgata is, in its nature, single and one.

"Mañjuśrī, just as one Tathāgata's qualities of buddhahood are measureless and his eloquence is measureless, so too, Mañjuśrī, having attained the meditative absorption of the Single Array, one should know the countless specific categories of Dharma-teachings belonging to the single principle of non-arising. All those who attain realization here — and whatever Dharma-teachings were proclaimed by the Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, and all that Ānanda fully retained — all those Dharma-teachings will become manifest here. Having accomplished this meditative absorption of the Single Array, for as long as the measure of one's life lasts, one will dwell and teach the Dharma together with its grounds and occasions.

"Mañjuśrī, regarding this, there are some who have set out on the bodhisattva vehicle who might think to themselves: 'What is this meditative absorption of the Single Array?'

To those people, one should say this: "Hold fast to and remain with the full, proper retention of these qualities proclaimed as inconceivable. In accordance with how thoroughly one takes them up and abides in them, one will come to see the qualities of this meditative absorption. Be without timidity in the manner that has been taught." This meditative absorption cannot be accomplished by those who hold to a view of an object of focus, nor by those who hold to a view of inherent existence, from those who see things as real entities up to and including those who maintain a view of existence.

Mañjuśrī, consider this example. Suppose a man possesses a priceless, incomparably precious jewel that has not been polished. Another man comes to him and asks: "Friend, how much is this precious jewel worth? What qualities does it have?" The man replies: "Friend, you should know that the qualities of this precious jewel are immeasurable upon immeasurable." Then the man, wishing to polish the jewel, places it with that person, saying: "Friend, please polish this jewel for now, and then you will come to know." The man then takes the jewel and polishes it with the instruments used for polishing. Through polishing it in this way, the precious jewel becomes priceless, and in accordance with how thoroughly he polishes it, one comes to see the qualities of the precious jewel. In just the same way, Mañjuśrī, whenever and to whatever degree a son or daughter of good family enters into and engages with this meditative absorption, to that same degree they will come to see the qualities of this meditative absorption.

Mañjuśrī, consider this further example. The rays of light from the sun's disc leave no part of the entire surface of the earth untouched. In just the same way, Mañjuśrī, one who has attained and entered the meditative absorption of the Single Array teaches nothing whatsoever that is not the Perfection of Wisdom. Moreover, if someone knows this practice otherwise than this, they will find no phenomenon that contradicts the non-arising of things.

Mañjuśrī, consider this example. If four men were to drink water from the four directions of the great ocean, each and every one of them would drink and draw water of a single taste — the taste of salt. In just the same way, Mañjuśrī, all the Dharma-teachings I have ever taught are of a single taste in just this way: the taste of non-arising, the taste of non-substantiality, the taste of freedom from attachment, the taste of liberation, and the taste of cessation.

Therefore, Mañjuśrī, whatever Dharma a son or daughter of good family who is endowed with this meditative absorption teaches, all of it will be taught as of a

single taste: the taste of non-arising, the taste of non-substantiality, the taste of freedom from attachment, the taste of liberation, and the taste of cessation. Having attained this meditative absorption, if a son or daughter of good family so wishes, they will be able to expound, explain, and demonstrate whatever Dharma I have taught.

Mañjuśrī, thus a son or daughter of good family who has attained this meditative absorption, whatever they may teach, will teach it all in the manner of non-referentiality — as not arisen, not produced, and without inherent substance.

Mañjuśrī, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, who has attained this meditative absorption will quickly complete the phenomena conducive to awakening and will swiftly come to attain, in full and perfect manifestation, the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

Mañjuśrī, furthermore, when a bodhisattva, a great being, comes to see neither arising nor ceasing, neither oneness nor multiplicity, anywhere from the sphere of self to the sphere of phenomena, then such a bodhisattva, a great being, endowed with this forbearance, will quickly come to attain, in full and perfect manifestation, the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

A son of good family who neither conceives of nor conceptually elaborates upon the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening — even this forbearance of his will bring him to obtain the qualities of a bodhisattva and the qualities of a buddha. And whoever, for the very sake of buddhahood, holds no aspiration toward awakening — even this forbearance, son of good family, is said to bring that person swiftly to the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

One who, with the conviction that all phenomena are the qualities of a buddha, does not become despondent — I declare such a one to be irreversible from the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening. That person is to be called inseparable from all the qualities of a buddha. And a son or daughter of good family who, upon hearing this teaching, does not become confused and does not fall into doubt — that person too is to be called inseparable from all the qualities of a buddha.

When this had been declared, Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, does the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening arise from a cause?

The Blessed One replied: Mañjuśrī, it does not. The unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening is not a cause, nor does it arise from a cause. Why is that? Because what is unborn and without substantial existence is neither a cause nor something that arises from a cause. And why is that? Because all phenomena are unborn.

Mañjuśrī, therefore, whatever sons or daughters of good family hear this teaching and do not become despondent — I declare them to be irreversible from the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

Mañjuśrī, therefore, whatever monks, nuns, laymen, or laywomen do not become despondent or dismayed when faced with this profound Perfection of Wisdom — they have come to me for refuge. They have gone forth under me. I am their Teacher.

Mañjuśrī, a son or daughter of good family who does not train in this profound Perfection of Wisdom does not train in the training of a bodhisattva.

Mañjuśrī, consider this example: all the clusters of elements, all the gatherings of seeds, all the grasses, creeping plants, medicines, and forests that exist — each and every one of them grows in dependence upon the great earth. In just the same way, Mañjuśrī, whatever wholesome qualities there may be among bodhisattvas, great beings — when all of them are fully taken up and embraced by the Perfection of Wisdom, they grow, expand, and become vast, and they do not deceive or lead astray on the path to the unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

When this had been declared, Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, regarding this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom that the Blessed One has expounded and set forth — will there be, in this Jambudvīpa, in villages, cities, towns, or regions, those who will take it up and those who will teach it?

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful:

Mañjuśrī, those who, upon hearing this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom in the present life, make the aspiration, "In my future lives too, may I hear this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom" — those people will come to progress from mere hearing all the way through to cultivating without extensive meditation.

Mañjuśrī, those who, upon hearing this profound Perfection of Wisdom, attain joy and expansive delight — I do not say that their roots of virtue are small.

Mañjuśrī, if there is someone who wishes to listen to this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom, and someone were to say to them, "Good son, what use is it for you to hear this? Having heard it, you will have no faith and you will turn away in disappointment" — why? Because here, no phenomenon whatsoever is taught as fully accomplished; nor are the phenomena of ordinary beings taught as arising or ceasing; nor are the phenomena of those in training, the phenomena of those beyond training, the phenomena of pratyekabuddhas, or the phenomena of buddhas taught as arising, ceasing, or being attained — if that were said, it should be replied in exactly these words.

When this had been declared, Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, if any monk, nun, layman, or laywoman were to come to me and ask, "What is this Dharma discourse that the Tathāgata gave today?" — Blessed One, to one who asks that, I would reply in these words: "It is a discourse that is not contradicted by any phenomenon whatsoever." Why? Because, Blessed One, there is no phenomenon that is contradicted by non-arising, and that discourse is not something that any sentient being finds easy to seek. Why? Because no sentient being whatsoever is apprehensible as an object.

Blessed One, I would further say to that person: "In this teaching, the phenomenon called non-arising has been set forth." Why? Because, Blessed One, all phenomena are equal in being without arising.

In that discourse, just as the phenomena of arhats have not demolished the phenomena of ordinary beings — that which the arhats have not realized has not been taught.

Blessed One, I would further say to that person: "In this teaching, there is no sentient being who has passed into nirvāṇa, nor who is passing into nirvāṇa, nor who will pass into nirvāṇa." Why? Because, Blessed One, sentient beings are utterly without apprehensible existence. If asked in that way, that is what I would say, Blessed One.

Blessed One, if someone who wishes to hear this profound Perfection of Wisdom from me were to ask, "What conversation did you have today with the Blessed One?" — I would reply to them in these words: "If you wish to hear it, do not settle your mind with the thought 'I will listen.' Do not arouse a thought of intention to listen. O noble one, cultivate a wisdom like the wisdom of an

illusory being, and with such wisdom one is able to know this teaching. O noble one, if you wish to hear this teaching, then abide like the track of a bird in the sky — and with such an attitude one is able to hear this teaching. O noble one, if you wish to hear this teaching, then do not apprehend duality as your object, and do not apprehend non-duality as your object either. Why? Because here there is nothing whatsoever that is to be expressed as duality, whether one expresses it fully as duality or expresses it as non-duality."

"If you wish to hear this teaching, do not destroy even the perceptions of self, and do not pass beyond those who have become engaged in views. Do not superimpose anything upon the qualities of the buddhas, and do not stir away from the qualities of ordinary beings." This is what I would say.

"Blessed One, whoever wishes to hear from me and asks — to that person I would say exactly this, I would teach exactly this, and I would present it in exactly this way. If a son of good family or a daughter of good family who thus asks were to abide in that way and enter in that way, then, for that one who rests in this seal of confidence, I would teach this teaching up until the Perfection of Wisdom is unborn, until there is nothing that exists, until it has not yet arisen."

When he had spoken these words, the Blessed One declared the following to Mañjuśrī, who is ever youthful: "Excellent, Mañjuśrī! Excellent! Mañjuśrī, it is excellent that you have spoken these words so well. You should then say the following to a son of good family or a daughter of good family: If you wish to behold the Tathāgata, then cultivate this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner of not meditating upon it. A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to pay homage to the Tathāgata should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner of not apprehending any object. A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to say 'the Tathāgata is my Teacher' should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner of not apprehending any object. A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, complete and perfect awakening should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner of having no deliberate striving. A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to attain mastery in all meditative absorptions should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner of not apprehending any object. A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to enter into all meditative absorptions should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner of not apprehending any object. And why? Because those

meditative absorptions are not fabricated.

A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to attain, as its culmination, the omniscient gnosis possessed of the highest excellence in all aspects should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner of there being nothing that exists. And why? Because this omniscient gnosis possessed of the highest excellence in all aspects is, in just this way, unfabricated, unborn, and without any existing thing.

A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to understand that all phenomena possess definite emergence, and that there is not a single phenomenon that does not possess definite emergence, should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner that reaches to there being nothing that exists. All phenomena are without definite emergence, and there is not a single phenomenon that possesses definite emergence. And why? Because all phenomena are unborn.

A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to understand that those phenomena do not exist in the way they are expressed, and that what is inexpressible does not exist and cannot be apprehended as an object, should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner that reaches to there being nothing that exists.

All sentient beings conduct themselves for the sake of awakening —"

"As for there being no sentient being whatsoever who does not conduct themselves for the sake of awakening — a son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to be without despondency even in the face of that should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner that reaches to there being nothing that exists. And why? Because all phenomena are equal to awakening. Just as all phenomena are equal to awakening, so too are all sentient beings exactly like awakening. Whatever the conduct of all sentient beings may be, that too is likewise. Since there is nothing, all conduct is conduct that is no conduct. And that too is awakening. What awakening is, that is also unborn. That too is unarisen. A son of good family or a daughter of good family who wishes to be without despondency with respect to such Dharma should train in this very Perfection of Wisdom in the manner that reaches to there being nothing that exists and to there being no birth."

So let it be spoken.

"Mañjuśrī, from the emanations of the Tathāgata through to the playful displays of the Tathāgata — all of these too are shown from within the Perfection of Wisdom itself. And why? Because it cannot be shown. The Perfection of Wisdom does not demonstrate anything.

Mañjuśrī, whatever monks, nuns, laymen, or laywomen take up even so much as a single four-line verse from this Perfection of Wisdom — who make it thoroughly complete, who bear it, recite it, and teach it correctly — if I were to declare even those to be irreversible, what need is there to say anything about those who realize it as suchness? Those sons of good family or daughters of good family should be recognized as certain for awakening.

Those who, upon hearing this profound Perfection of Wisdom — which is unborn, in which there is nothing that exists, and which is unarisen — do not become frightened, terrified, or dismayed, those are ones who abide in the domain of the buddhas. If they go on to have faith, they will become certain of all the qualities of the buddhas.

Mañjuśrī, this seal, which was granted by the buddhas, fully known by the Tathāgatas, and rightly confirmed by all the arhats, is to be established here. This seal is established for those who realize equality. This fully shows the absence of attachment even up to all the qualities of the buddhas.

Mañjuśrī, a son of good family or a daughter of good family of the bodhisattva vehicle who is sealed with this seal is not one destined for the lower rebirths, nor is such a person destined to go toward or enter the ground of the śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas."

Then at that time, Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, and the divine sons of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three offered divine sandalwood powder, divine golden powder, the divine flowers mandārava and great mandārava, divine incense, divine blue lotuses, white water-lilies, white lotuses, and the sounds of divine music in veneration of this Perfection of Wisdom. They also scattered and abundantly scattered offerings before the Blessed One and the youthful Mañjuśrī, and spoke these words: "Through this root of virtue, may those who are sealed with this seal come to venerate this precious Dharma that is unsurpassed, and may they go on to hear it again and again in future lives."

Śakra, lord of the gods, then spoke these words: "Blessed One, may this profound Perfection of Wisdom, which is unarisen and unborn, come to be practiced here in Jambudvīpa, and may sons of good family or

daughters of good family such as these come to hear it — and from the moment it reaches their ears, until they themselves have fully accomplished all the qualities of a buddha — I will strive with diligence on their behalf.

Blessed One, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family hears even a little of this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom as it reaches their ears, and upon hearing it gains faith, and upon gaining faith takes hold of it, makes it thoroughly complete, and bears it — may those sons of good family and daughters of good family have no doubt whatsoever, thinking: "This has been accomplished for us by the gods."

When these words had been spoken, the Blessed One said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Kauśika, it is just so. Regard all the qualities of a buddha as being accomplished in those sons of good family and daughters of good family. Know with certainty that they are destined for unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I beseech you to bless this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom for the sake of those sons of good family and daughters of good family. Sugata, I beseech you to bestow your blessing."

The moment these words were spoken, at that very instant, by the power of the buddhas, the great earth shook in six ways. And the very moment the great earth shook, the Blessed One then smiled. The very moment the Blessed One smiled, the Tathāgata bestowed his blessing upon this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom, and this world-system of the great trichiliocosm was pervaded by a great radiance.

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, this is an auspicious sign that the Tathāgata has blessed this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, it is just so. Mañjuśrī, these are the auspicious signs that the Tathāgata has blessed this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom. By these signs, know that this teaching of the Perfection of Wisdom has been blessed.

Mañjuśrī, those who do not abandon any dharma whatsoever, do not turn away from any, and do not praise any — know that they are sealed with this seal. And why is that? Because when there is an object, one abandons and one praises. Therefore, Mañjuśrī, it is for the sake of those who are sealed with this

seal that I have established this seal — for, having heard it, they neither point out nor conceptually engage with any dharma whatsoever. And why is that? Because, Mañjuśrī, all phenomena are ultimately unarisen."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the youthful Mañjuśrī, and those great bodhisattvas, and those great śrāvakas, and the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced, and they wholeheartedly praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This completes the forty-sixth chapter, called "The Seven Hundred Perfection of Wisdom, the Chapter Requested by Mañjuśrī," from the noble great Dharma discourse entitled the Mahāratnakūṭa, in one hundred thousand sections.

Translated by the Indian scholar Surendrabodhi and the great translator-editor, the monk Yeshe De, who revised and established the final text.

Translator's Notes

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the provided passage. The translation renders exactly what is given.

The term rendered "ten million" throughout represents the Tibetan "sa ya," which corresponds to a Sanskrit unit of one hundred thousand or, in some usages, one million. In Buddhist canonical lists the figure is often formulaic and hyperbolic; the precise numerical value is less important than its sense of an immeasurably vast assembly.

"Śes-sde translation team" refers to the well-known Tibetan royal-period translation bureau associated with Śilendrabodhi and Ye-shes-sde, who produced and revised many Perfection of Wisdom translations in the late eighth and early ninth centuries.

- The passage's repeated formula "suchness neither arises nor ceases" appears twice in close succession in the Tibetan, which may reflect a scribal duplication or a deliberate rhetorical doubling; the translation preserves both occurrences as found in the text.
- The phrase rendered "as many as there are buddha-qualities" translates a response that equates the number of sentient beings with the buddha-qualities, a deliberately paradoxical answer subverting the question's presupposition. The Tibetan reads literally "as many as the buddha's qualities, that many," which I have rendered accordingly.

The passage ends mid-exchange; Mañjuśrī's final reply to the question about whether roots of virtue increase or diminish is cut off at the passage boundary.

- The phrase rendered "the ultimate limit" translates "yang dag pa'i mtha'" (Skt. bhūtakoti), a standard Madhyamaka term for the absolute boundary or limit of reality, synonymous with suchness. This is a consequential doctrinal term worth noting, though the rendering is unambiguous in context.
- The phrase rendered "does not cognize anything distinctly" translates rnam par mi rig pa, which literally means something like "not being aware in a differentiated way" or "not distinctly cognizing." In this context it points to a meditative non-discrimination rather than ordinary ignorance, and so is rendered accordingly rather than with the pejorative "ignorance."

- The phrase rendered "without there being any seeing" translates a construction meaning that the seeing itself is not grasped as a real act of seeing — the absence of a reified perceiving subject is the point. The doctrinal nuance is that genuine insight into buddha-qualities arises precisely when the act of perceiving them is not hypostatized.
- The name rendered as "the sister Anāpalambhā" translates མཉམ་པ་ལྷོ་མ་ — literally "the sister who-is-without-apprehension / Anāpalambhā." This appears to be a named female figure in the assembly, whose name is itself a doctrinal term meaning "without apprehension" or "ungraspable." The rendering preserves both the title "sister" (མཉམ་པ་, a female assembly member, possibly a nun) and her name. If this is a known canonical figure under a different standard rendering, a specialist may wish to adjust.

The exchange on the "perishable collection" (སྐྱོད་པ་ལྷོ་མ་, skandhas / satkāya) playing on the etymology of the term — "that which disintegrates / perishes" yet is said not to truly exist and therefore not to truly pass over — is a standard Prajñāpāramitā dialectical move and is rendered faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "receive it upon the crown of their heads" translates a conventional expression of highest reverence, literally taking something to the top of the head, meaning to accept it with utmost respect and devotion.

The exchange between Mañjuśrī and the Blessed One reflects a classic Perfection of Wisdom dialectic: any aspiration toward awakening as an object would reify it, and any practice framed as "non-apprehension" would itself become an apprehended dharma — a subtle point preserved in the translation without smoothing.

- The phrase rendered "set down the great elephant, do not stir the great elephant" is a deliberate non-answer — an apophatic deflection by Mañjuśrī that sidesteps the question of how he sees the Tathāgata. The image may allude to the classic simile of blind men and an elephant, implying that any conceptual grasp of the Tathāgata is similarly partial and misleading. The precise rhetorical function is clear from context, but the specific provenance of this idiom within this sūtra is worth noting.

The recurring technical phrase rendered "the word for" translates a Tibetan construction meaning literally "whose word / the word belonging to what" — conveying the philosophical question of what referent, if any, a given term actually names.

- The paradoxical statements about monks "without faith" and "not fit" being worthy recipients of offerings, and about "one who has not destroyed moral discipline" being an arhat, are deliberate doctrinal inversions characteristic of this text's non-dual rhetoric. They turn on the principle that conventional distinctions (faith/no faith, fit/unfit, transgression/discipline) dissolve in the light of the dharmadhātu's equality. The translator has rendered them literally, preserving the paradox rather than smoothing it over.

The phrase rendered "a monk of non-abiding" renders mi gnas pa'i dge slong, which could also be read as "a monk who does not remain" or "an unestablished monk"; "non-abiding" captures the technical non-dual resonance most fully.

- The "five uninterrupted states" renders "ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" (literally "the five without interval"). In standard Abhidharma usage this term refers to the five actions of immediate retribution (ānantarya-karma), the gravest negative deeds. Mañjuśrī's paradoxical equation of awakening with these five is a classic non-dual rhetorical move found in several Vimalakīrti-style sūtras, where the most extreme negativity and the highest attainment are shown to share the same unborn, essenceless nature. The doctrinal point is preserved in the translation but listeners unfamiliar with the term may find the logic surprising without further commentary.

- The phrase rendered "those with arrogant presumption" translates a construction meaning those possessing pride or presumption in the mode of direct realization. The passage is making an ironic doctrinal point: those who conceptually bracket awakening between "complete buddhahood" and "direct perception" thereby reveal their conceit, since by the logic just established, awakening transcends all such reference points. This is a subtle and intentional paradox in the text.

The logic of the final exchange rests on the Madhyamaka identification of the Tathāgata with the dharmadhātu and suchness: because the dharmadhātu neither arises nor ceases, buddhas cannot truly "appear" or "pass into nirvāṇa" in any ultimately real sense, and all buddhas are therefore a single, inconceivable, undivided domain.

- The opening sentence is structurally complex in the Tibetan, with Mañjuśrī apparently addressing the Blessed One in a somewhat inverted construction that echoes back to the previous exchange. The rendering follows the doctrinal logic: the statement about buddhas who have not yet appeared attaining awakening in the same way is Mañjuśrī's conclusion from the preceding exchange, not the Blessed One's own direct speech. The passage ends mid-dialogue as the Tibetan source breaks off, and this is rendered faithfully without completion.

- The phrase rendered "neither increase nor diminish" for the seeds planted in the field carries a nuance worth noting: the Tibetan indicates they neither proliferate nor are exhausted, pointing to the beyond-causal nature of the inconceivable field — seeds sown in ultimate reality are not subject to the ordinary logic of karmic growth or depletion.

The epithet "Śāriputra" is the standard rendering of Śāradvatīputra, son of Śāradvatī, used throughout.

- The archery simile — striking "oxhair targets" — refers to the classical Indian archery exercise of striking a bundle or tip of ox-hair, used as a mark of extraordinary precision. The Tibetan "ba lang gi phur pa" means literally "ox-hair tips," which corresponds to the Sanskrit gomayalakṣya or a similar compound; this is an established simile for effortless mastery.

The passage ends mid-sentence with Mañjuśrī's reply beginning but not yet completed in the supplied text; the translation ends accordingly.

- The equational chain in the final paragraph — cycling through "inconceivable basic space," "basic space of non-arising," "dharmadhātu," "basic space of utter non-origination," and "basic space of self" — is a deliberate rhetorical and doctrinal device showing the synonymity and non-duality of these terms. The rendering "basic space of self" for སྤྱི་བཟོ་སྤྱི་བཟོ་ is intentional: this is a provocative use of the term "self" (ātman) in a non-substantialist sense to indicate the ultimate, insubstantial ground, a usage consistent with certain Perfection of Wisdom sūtra registers. The phrase སྤྱི་བཟོ་སྤྱི་བཟོ་སྤྱི་བཟོ་སྤྱི་བཟོ་ is rendered "best expressed by the words 'the inconceivable basic space'" — the phrase སྤྱི་བཟོ་སྤྱི་བཟོ་ literally means the words are "superb" or "the finest expression," indicating an approximate or exemplary verbal pointing rather than a definition.

- The phrase rendered "equal of the unequal" translates mi mnyam pa dang mnyam pa, a well-attested epithet of buddha-wisdom in Perfection of Wisdom literature meaning it equals what has no equal, i.e., it surpasses all comparison. This is a standard Prajñāpāramitā formula rather than a logical paradox requiring resolution.

The sentence about primordial wisdom being "not born before, nor unborn before" and the inference that what is not unborn cannot cease is a compressed dialectical argument: the usual basis for asserting cessation is prior arising; if arising itself cannot be established, cessation equally cannot be established. This is standard Madhyamaka reasoning embedded in the sūtra.

- The *kārṣāpaṇa* is an ancient Indian coin or weight unit. The point of the analogy is that an unstamped blank coin is neither fully "altered" (minted and put into circulation) nor "unaltered" in any meaningful finished sense — it occupies a category that transcends both designations, just as primordial wisdom transcends the made and the unmade.

The phrase rendered "from the beginning down to the absence of inherent existence" translates a Tibetan sequence listing a range of qualities: unborn, unarisen, naturally completely passed beyond sorrow, down to the absence of things — this appears to be a condensed doctrinal chain indicating the full scope of the Perfection of Wisdom's ultimate character.

- The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan, cutting off after the list of mental responses following the city analogy. The translation reproduces exactly as much as the source text provides.

The "grove of the *Pāricchataka* tree" refers to the *Pārijāta* or *Pāricchataka* tree, the divine coral tree of the Thirty-Three gods' heaven whose blossoming signals a time of celestial rejoicing. The image is a standard simile in *Mahāyāna* literature for the imminent flourishing of Dharma.

The phrase rendered "from 'unborn' through 'without inherent existence' and 'has not arisen'" follows the Tibetan's compressed back-reference to the doctrinal formula and is deliberately kept brief as a citation marker.

- The phrase rendered "from the unborn and unarisen to the very absence of things" is a recurring formula in this passage. The Tibetan "ma skyes pa dang ma byung ba nas dngos po med pa'i bar" designates the full range of the Perfection of Wisdom's content as characterized by non-arising and the absence of real entities. This is a technical *Prajñāpāramitā* formulation indicating that the teaching encompasses the entire spectrum from the non-arising of phenomena to their ultimate non-substantiality.

The phrase "from faith all the way to complete mastery" renders "mos pa nas kun chub par byed pa'i bar du byed pa," which describes a progression from initial aspiration or confident faith through to full comprehension, denoting the range of practitioners who engage with the text at different levels.

- The phrase rendered "does not analyze, generate, or reveal the thorough accomplishment of any phenomenon" translates a slightly compressed Tibetan clause. The three verbs — analyzing or breaking down, generating, and revealing or demonstrating — describe ways one might expect a teaching to operate on phenomena. The point is that the Perfection of Wisdom does none of these, because phenomena have no inherent completion or establishment to be operated upon. This is a subtle *Madhyamaka* doctrinal point and the rendering aims to preserve that nuance.

The "wheel of Dharma turned in twelve aspects by being spoken three times" is the classical formulation of the first turning at *Vārāṇasī*: the four Noble Truths each presented in three phases — recognition, function, and accomplishment — yielding twelve aspects in total.

- The phrase rendered "not in the manner of training through mere aspiration" translates a construction meaning training without treating it as mere intellectual interest or wishful inclination, but through direct non-conceptual engagement. The Tibetan is slightly compressed here and the rendering follows the most natural doctrinal reading.

- The epithet "Ever-Youthful" renders the standard Tibetan addition to *Mañjuśrī*'s name, *gzhon nur gyur pa*, which reflects the Sanskrit *kumārabhūta*, meaning "one who has become like a prince" or "ever-youthful." This is consistent usage in this *sūtra*.

The phrase rendered "Ānanda fully retained" translates Kun dga' bos ji snyed yongs su bzung ba, literally "as much as Ānanda fully held." This refers to Ānanda's famous role as the disciple who memorized all the Buddha's discourses, serving as the basis for the canonical recitation at the First Council. The passage is saying that all such remembered teachings become manifest in this samādhi.

The term bkod pa gcig pa (Single Array) is rendered consistently throughout. The Blessed One explains it as a synonym for non-arising, suggesting the Sanskrit ekavyūha; the passage is likely the Pratyutpannabuddhasaṃmukhāvasthitasamādhi-sūtra or a closely related text describing this samādhi.

- The phrase rendered "taste of non-substantiality" translates a term literally meaning "the taste of the absence of real entities," which points to the Madhyamaka doctrine that phenomena lack inherent substantiality. The five "tastes" here form a doctrinal list closely related to standard formulations of the flavor of liberation found across Mahāyāna sūtra literature.
- The phrase rendered "sphere of self to the sphere of phenomena" translates "bdag gi dbyings nas chos kyi dbyings kyi bar du" — literally "from the space of self to the space of phenomena." The term dbyings here parallels dharmadhātu and suggests the full range of experience from the personal to the universal.

The word "nur ba" appears twice near the end of the passage. It likely conveys being crestfallen, dispirited, or cringing — a nuance distinct from "zhum pa" (despondent), which appears alongside it. Both are rendered with close but distinct English equivalents to preserve the pairing.

- The passage "just as the phenomena of arhats have not demolished the phenomena of ordinary beings — that which the arhats have not realized has not been taught" is syntactically compressed and somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan. The sense appears to be that, in this discourse of non-arising, the distinction between ordinary phenomena and arhat-attainment phenomena is not hierarchically imposed; what remains unrealized by arhats is not a subject of this teaching either. This is a genuinely difficult clause and the doctrinal point deserves attention from a specialist commentator.
- The two statements about "definite emergence" present a dialectical reversal: first, all phenomena possess definite emergence; second, all phenomena are without definite emergence. This apparent contradiction is resolved by the closing reason: all phenomena are unborn and therefore ultimately neither emerge nor fail to emerge. The Tibetan "nges par 'byung ba" carries the dual sense of "definite arising" and "definite emergence" or "renunciation." Here the cosmological and ontological sense of "arising" is intended, not the soteriological sense of "going forth from worldly life," though the ambiguity may be deliberate.
- The phrase rendered "without despondency" translates བྱེད་པ་མེད་པའི་སྣང་བ་, which could also be rendered "wishing to be undaunted" or "aspiring to be undismayed." The sense is one of spiritual fortitude in the face of the profound teaching; the rendering chosen reflects this consistently throughout the passage.
- The colophon identifies the text as chapter forty-six of the Mahāratnakūṭa Sūtra, specifically the Saptaśatikā Prajñāpāramitā (Seven Hundred Perfection of Wisdom) in the version requested by Mañjuśrī. The phrase rendered "does not abandon, does not turn away from, and does not praise any dharma" encapsulates a key Madhyamaka point: the seal of non-conceptual engagement means neither rejecting nor affirming any phenomenon as truly existent — because all concepts of object, rejection, and praise presuppose a referent, which the Perfection of Wisdom dissolves through the recognition of universal non-arising. The six modes of earth-shaking are a standard canonical omen (in both directions: physical and qualitative) marking a moment of great spiritual significance.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.